



WEEK FIVE · MODULE ONE

The Operational Toolkit

Sourcing, logistics, vendors, budgets and staff, the systems that make excellence repeatable

THE PRIVATE CONCIERGE ACADEMY

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HOW TO STUDY THIS MODULE

The first four weeks built your posture. This week builds your capability, and it is the least glamorous and the most immediately employable material in the programme.

Everything here is a system. Systems can be learned in a week and take a career to hold.

Your deliverable is your own operations toolkit: the templates you will actually use in a house. Build it as you read.

CHAPTER I

The operating system

Six domains, and how they fail

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Map any household onto the six operational domains.

Understand that every domain fails in a predictable way.

1.1 · The domains

Every private household, whatever its size, runs on six operational domains. A two-person flat in Paris and a six-residence family office have exactly the same six. Only the scale changes.

Domain	What it covers, and how it fails
The brief	How instructions enter the system. Fails when an instruction is heard rather than confirmed, and the failure surfaces three weeks later.
Sourcing	Finding and vetting the people who do the work. Fails when a supplier is chosen for their price or their charm rather than their discretion.
Money	Budgets, thresholds, spend, reconciliation. Fails quietly, and it is the failure that ends careers even when nothing was stolen.
Logistics	Movement of people and things. Fails at handovers, always, and never in the middle.
The residence	The physical asset. Fails through deferred maintenance, and deferred maintenance is always cheaper today and always ruinous later.
Staff	The people. Fails through unclear authority, and unclear authority is the normal condition of your role.

1.2 · What this week is really teaching

Not tasks. **Systems.** A person who can book a flight is worth what a person who can book a flight is worth. A person who has a travel system that never fails, that survives their own

absence, and that a replacement could pick up tomorrow, is worth six times as much and is almost never available.

The test of every system in this module is the same: **would it still work if you were unavailable for a week and nobody could reach you?** If the answer is no, you have not built a system. You have built a dependency on yourself, and a dependency is not an asset, it is a risk, and houses eventually remove risks.

CHAPTER II

The brief

How an instruction is taken, and why most people take them badly

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Take a brief correctly, and confirm it in writing.

Understand the six questions that must be answered before you act.

2.1 · Where things actually go wrong

Most operational failures in private service are not failures of execution. They are failures of the brief. Someone said "book somewhere nice for Thursday", and everyone was satisfied, and nothing was true.

2.2 · The six questions

Every instruction, before you move: who, what, when, where, how much, and who else knows. If any of the six is missing, the brief is incomplete, and an incomplete brief is a decision you are about to make on their behalf.

Question	What you are pinning down
Who	Exactly who is attending, travelling, being served. Not "the family". Names, and how many, and any guests, and whether the guests know each other.
What	The actual outcome desired, not the task requested. "Somewhere nice" is not an outcome. A quiet table, no photographs, a kitchen that will handle an allergy, is an outcome.
When	The times, including the ones nobody stated: when do they need to leave, not when do they need to arrive.
Where	The place, and the alternative, and whether the place matters at all or whether it is the outcome that matters.
How much	The threshold. Ask early, ask once, and never test it.

Question**What you are pinning down**

Who else knows

Who else in the house, in the office, in the staff, is aware of this and needs to be. Half of all operational failures are a person who should have been told and was not.

2.3 · The confirmation

DEFINITION

The confirmation. A short written message, sent within the hour, restating the instruction as you understood it. Never a request for approval. A statement of understanding.

"Understood: dinner Thursday, eight o'clock, four people, quiet table, no photographs, the allergy noted with the kitchen, car at seven forty. I will confirm the table today."

It takes forty seconds. It has saved more careers than any other habit in this profession, and it does two things at once: it catches the misunderstanding while it is still free, and it produces the written record that Week 3 taught you to keep.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

Most failures are failures of the brief, not of execution.

Six questions before you move: who, what, when, where, how much, who else knows.

Confirm in writing, within the hour, as a statement of understanding rather than a request for approval.

CHAPTER III

Sourcing and the black book

How the supply side of this world actually works

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Source and vet a supplier to the standard of a private household.

Build a black book that is an asset rather than a liability.

3.1 · What a black book actually is

DEFINITION

The black book. Your private, vetted, tiered list of people who deliver at this level: their names, what they are genuinely good at, what they are not, what they cost, and whether they can be trusted with a confidence.

It is the single most portable asset in this profession. It travels with you, it grows for thirty years, and it is a large part of why an experienced estate manager is paid what she is paid. And it is not the list of names. It is the fact that they answer.

3.2 · The four tiers

Tier	What it means
Tier 1	You have used them personally, more than once, including on a difficult day. They have never disappointed you and they have never repeated anything. You would put them in front of a principal without hesitating.
Tier 2	You have used them and they were good. Not yet tested under pressure. Perfectly acceptable for the ordinary work, never for the important thing.
Tier 3	Recommended by someone you trust, and not yet used. Useful, and not yet real. Most people's entire black book is tier 3, and they do not know it.
Tier 4	Found. Advertised. Impressive website. Unknown. This is not a supplier, it is a candidate.

3.3 · Vetting, in the order that matters

- **Discretion first, always.** Have they worked with families of this profile, and what did they say about it when you asked? The supplier who tells you, warmly and helpfully, who else they work for, has just told you exactly what they will say about you.
- **Insurance and legal standing.** Registered, insured, and able to show you the certificate without a delay. This is not bureaucracy: an uninsured contractor in a house is a catastrophe with a date on it.
- **Capacity under pressure.** Not what they do on a good day. What they did the last time everything went wrong. Ask them. The answer, and the willingness to give it, is the whole interview.
- **References from a peer, not from a website.** One conversation with another estate manager is worth more than every testimonial ever published.
- **Price, last.** It comes last for a reason. Price is the only thing on this list you can negotiate, and the only one that is not a risk.

THE RULE OF THE BLACK BOOK

A supplier who talks about their other clients will talk about you.

It does not matter how good they are, how convenient they are, or how much the principal likes them. This is a permanent disqualification, and you will be tempted to make an exception, and you must not.

3.4 · Protecting it

Your black book is yours, and the household's suppliers are the household's. That distinction is not always obvious and it matters enormously. A supplier you brought in remains in your book. A supplier the family has used for twenty years is not yours to take anywhere, and their contact details are household information under the Week 3 classification.

CHAPTER IV

Money

The domain that ends careers without anyone stealing anything

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Operate a budget, a threshold and a reconciliation to a professional standard.

Understand why proximity to money is the most dangerous part of the role.

4.1 · The principle, before any technique

THE ONLY RULE THAT MATTERS

You will handle a great deal of money that is not yours, and almost nobody will check.

That is the entire risk. It is not theft: almost nobody in this profession steals. It is sloppiness, and rounding, and a receipt that was lost, and an expense that was never quite explained. And sloppiness with money looks exactly like dishonesty from the outside, and it is treated as though it were.

4.2 · The threshold

Every house has a figure above which you must ask. It is almost never written down, and almost nobody will tell you what it is. Establish it in your first week, explicitly, by asking. "What is the level above which you would want me to check with you first?" It is a professional question, it will be respected, and it is the cheapest insurance you will ever buy.

And then never test it. Not once, not for a good reason, not because you were obviously right. Read the case of the two thousand euros again, in Week 4.

4.3 · The systems

System

How it is actually run

The budget

Annual, by category: household, staff, maintenance, travel, provisions, entertaining. Reviewed monthly against actuals, and the variance explained in one line, before anyone asks.

System	How it is actually run
The card	A household card, in the household's name, never your own. If you are ever asked to put a household expense on your personal card, it happens once, it is reimbursed within the week, and you find another way. A pattern of personal-card spending is how good people end up in conversations they cannot win.
Receipts	Every one. Photographed the same day, filed against the category, no exceptions for small amounts. The small amounts are where the doubt starts.
Reconciliation	Monthly, and you present it before it is requested. A statement nobody asked for, delivered on the second of every month, is worth more to your standing than any single thing you will do all year.
Petty cash	The most dangerous object in a household. Logged to the euro, counted weekly, and never mixed with your own. If you cannot account for eleven euros, you have a problem, and the problem is not the eleven euros.

4.4 · Commissions, and the word for it

Suppliers in this world will offer you money. Not crudely. It will be called a referral fee, a courtesy, a small thank you, an industry standard. It is sometimes even normal in their sector.

You decline it, and you tell the house that it was offered. Both halves matter. Declining protects your integrity. Telling them protects you from the day they find out that it was offered and you said nothing, which is a day that arrives more often than you would expect.

The moment your supplier selection is influenced by what a supplier pays you, you are no longer working for the family. You are working against them, from inside their house, and there is no coming back from that, ever, in any house, anywhere.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

Establish the threshold in week one, by asking. Then never test it.

Receipts the same day, reconciliation on the second of every month, delivered before it is requested.

Commissions are declined and disclosed. Both. Every time.

CHAPTER V

Logistics

Movement, and the fact that it always breaks at the seams

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Build a travel file that a stranger could execute.

Run an advance, and understand the handover as the point of failure.

5.1 · The travel file

One document. Everything on it. Printed as well as digital, because the day it matters is the day the telephone is dead.

Section	What goes in it
The movement	Every leg, with times, and, next to each, the time they must leave rather than the time it departs. Buffers built in and not stated.
The people	Who is travelling, passport numbers held securely by the office, visas, expiry dates checked and not assumed. A passport within six months of expiry is a crisis waiting for a border.
The ground	Every car, every driver, name and telephone number, and the second option for each. This is where it fails.
The property	Hotel or residence, the room, the arrival standard: what is in the room before they walk in, and who put it there.
The contacts	One name and one number per link in the chain, and a named person at each end of every handover. Not a company. A person.
The contingencies	What happens if the flight is delayed. If the car does not come. If a bag is lost. Written, in advance, in one line each, so that nobody is inventing at midnight.

5.2 · Aviation, in one page

You do not need to be an aviation expert. You need to know what you are looking at, what the questions are, and who to call.

Mode	What you need to understand
Commercial, first or business	More common at this level than the newspapers imagine. Seat preferences recorded. Lounge and fast-track arranged. Ground crew briefed on the arrival, not on the person.
Charter	Priced per flight, not per seat. You are quoted for the aircraft and the routing, and the quote varies enormously between brokers for exactly the same aeroplane. Always take two quotes, always. Ask about repositioning costs, which is where a cheap quote hides.
Empty leg	A repositioning flight sold at a heavy discount. Genuinely useful, entirely unreliable, and it can be cancelled. It is never the plan for a meeting that matters. It can be excellent for a return with flexibility.
Fractional and cards	Pre-purchased hours, guaranteed availability, a fixed hourly rate. If the family already have this, learn the rules of their programme in your first week: the notice period, the peak days, the cancellation terms. This is entirely learnable and almost nobody bothers.

5.3 · The advance

DEFINITION

The advance. Going ahead of the principal to the place they are about to be, and resolving everything that would otherwise be discovered by them.

The room is checked. The temperature is set. The water is right. The route is driven, once, at the hour it will be driven, not at three in the afternoon when the road is empty. **Nothing** about the arrival is discovered in front of the principal.

5.4 · The seams

Learn this and you will never lose a day to it: **logistics do not fail in the middle. They fail at the handovers.** Between the car and the aircraft. Between the driver and the hotel. Between what the office booked and what the house believes. At every seam, there is a named person on both sides, and they have each other's number, and they have spoken before the day.

CHAPTER VI

The yacht

The most expensive object you will ever be asked to handle

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Understand who is who on a yacht, and who you may and may not speak to.

Read a charter contract, and understand the APA, which is where every mistake happens.

Coordinate with a captain without ever appearing to give him an order.

6.1 · Why this chapter exists

If your family owns a yacht, or charters one for August, you will find yourself handling sums of money and a chain of command unlike anything else in the household. A week aboard a decent charter yacht in the Mediterranean costs more than most people earn in a year, and the person who gets the details wrong is almost never the captain. It is the person on land who booked it.

You do not need to be a yacht professional. **You need to know who is who, what the words mean, and where the money actually goes.** That is what this chapter gives you, and it is enough.

6.2 · Who is who, and who you speak to

Who	What they do, and how you deal with them
The captain	Absolute authority aboard, on everything, and this is a matter of law and not of ego. He decides where the vessel goes, whether it goes at all, and who comes aboard. You never give the captain an instruction. You pass on the principal's wishes, and you ask what is possible.
The chief stewardess	Your real counterpart, and the person who will make your summer easy or impossible. Interior, service, provisioning, guest preferences. Send her the preference file before the guests arrive, in writing, and she will remember you for years.

Who	What they do, and how you deal with them
The charter broker	Represents the client, meaning you. Finds the vessel, negotiates the contract, holds the funds. Paid a commission by the owner's side, typically around fifteen per cent, which is normal, disclosed, and not your problem.
The central agent	Represents the yacht and its owner, not you. Pleasant, helpful, and on the other side of the table. Never confuse the two.
The yacht manager	Runs the vessel as an asset for the owner: crew, maintenance, compliance, insurance. If your family owns rather than charters, this is the person you will speak to every week.
The purser	On larger vessels, the person who holds the accounts. If there is a purser, the APA questions go to the purser, and everything becomes considerably easier.

6.3 · The words you must know

The word	What it actually means
Charter fee	The base price of the vessel and her crew for the period. This is the number people quote, and it is never the number you pay.
APA	Advance Provisioning Allowance. Typically twenty-five to thirty-five per cent of the charter fee, paid in advance, held by the captain, and spent on fuel, food, drink, port fees, dockage and everything else. It is the family's money, held on trust, and it is reconciled at the end. Learn this word tonight.
MYBA agreement	The standard charter contract in the Mediterranean. Read it. The clauses that matter are the cancellation terms, the delivery and redelivery ports, and what happens in bad weather.
VAT	Charged on the charter fee, and it varies enormously by country and by itinerary. It is a large number. Ask the broker to state it in writing, before you present a total to the principal.
Delivery / redelivery	Where the charter starts and ends. Changing it costs money, sometimes a great deal, and it is one of the most common late requests you will receive.
Crew gratuity	Customary, and not automatic. In the Mediterranean, five to fifteen per cent of the charter fee, at the principal's discretion, usually given to the captain to distribute. Raise it with the principal quietly, in advance, so that nobody is improvising on the last morning.

THE ONE NUMBER THAT CATCHES EVERYBODY

The principal is told the yacht costs 200,000 for the week. The real figure, with APA and VAT, is closer to 290,000 before a single tip.

If you present the charter fee as the price, you have not lied, and you have set up a conversation that will go very badly. **Always present the all-in figure, in writing, with the three lines separated. Charter fee. APA. VAT. Then the total.**

6.4 · The APA, and where the trouble is

The APA is the single most misunderstood thing in yachting, and it is where your reputation will be made or lost.

- **It is not a fee. It is the family's money.** The captain holds it and spends it on their behalf, and every euro must be accounted for at the end of the charter.
- **You ask for the running balance, mid-charter, politely and in writing.** A good captain provides it without being asked. A captain who is vague about the APA is a captain you note in your file.
- **You read the final reconciliation, line by line.** Fuel, berthing, provisions, ordered wine, guest requests. If something is unclear, you ask once, calmly, before the yacht leaves.
- **If it runs low mid-charter, the captain will ask for a top-up.** This is normal and it is not a warning sign. What matters is that you saw it coming, because you asked for the balance on day three.
- **Anything left over is returned to the family.** If nobody chases it, sometimes it is not. You chase it.

6.5 · How you actually work with the crew

Every rule from this programme applies aboard, and two of them apply with force.

The rule	Why it matters more at sea
You never contradict the captain in front of the principal	Not on weather, not on the itinerary, not on whether the tender can run at midnight. If you disagree, you speak to him alone, once, and then you support his decision entirely. His authority is not a preference. It is the safety of everyone aboard.
You brief the chief stewardess in writing, early	The preference file, the allergies, the sleeping arrangements, the drinks, the music, the children. Send it a week ahead, not on the morning of embarkation. This single habit will make you her favourite person on land.

The rule

Why it matters more at sea

You never go aboard as a guest

Even when invited, and you will be invited. You are working, you are dressed for working, and you leave the moment the family are settled. The staff member who is found sunbathing on the aft deck is the staff member nobody trusts again.

You handle the tip conversation early and privately

Never at the passerelle on the last morning, in front of the crew, with everybody waiting. Discuss it with the principal quietly, three days before, and have the envelope ready.

THE SENTENCE THAT SAVES YOU

"Captain, the principal would like to be in Portofino for dinner on Thursday. What is possible?"

Never: "we need to be in Portofino by Thursday." You have just given an order to a man who is legally responsible for the vessel, and you have done it about weather you cannot see, and he will remember it for the rest of the season.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

The captain has absolute authority aboard. You pass on wishes and you ask what is possible.

Learn the APA. It is the family money, held by the captain, and you ask for the balance mid-charter and read the reconciliation line by line.

Never present the charter fee as the price. Charter fee, APA, VAT, total. In writing, always.

CHAPTER VII

The residence

The asset, and the maintenance that is always cheaper today

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Run a residence on a calendar rather than on emergencies.
- Manage a contractor without being managed by one.

7.1 · The maintenance calendar

A house that is run on emergencies costs three times what a house run on a calendar costs, and it is exhausting, and the exhaustion is visible, and visible strain is what Week 4 told you is being counted.

Rhythm	What is on it
Weekly	The walk-through. You, alone, every room, with a notebook. Ten minutes. It catches everything that would otherwise become a crisis in March.
Monthly	Systems: heating, water, alarms, cameras, vehicles, generators, pool plant. Each has an owner and a date, and the date is met.
Quarterly	Deep clean, gardens and grounds by season, inventory spot-check, insurance and compliance documents reviewed.
Annual	Insurance renewal, valuations, the inventory in full, contracts and rates renegotiated, the maintenance budget rebuilt from what actually happened rather than from what was budgeted last year.

7.2 · Contractors in the house

- **They sign something.** Confidentiality, at minimum, for anyone who crosses the threshold. This is normal, it is expected at this level, and a contractor who resists is telling you something.
- **They are supervised.** Nobody works unaccompanied in a private residence. Nobody. Not the celebrated architect, not the twenty-year electrician, not the one the principal likes.

- **They arrive and leave through the agreed door, at the agreed hours.** A renovation is a security breach that lasts four months, and it is the single most common way a household is compromised.
- **Nothing is photographed.** Not for their portfolio, not for their instagram, not "just for the file". This is a written term, not a conversation.
- **The scope is written and the variations are written.** Every project in the history of the world has grown. The ones that end badly are the ones where nobody wrote down when it grew, or who agreed.

7.3 · The inventory

Photographed, valued, insured, updated. Art, furniture, wine, watches, vehicles. It is tedious, it takes weeks, and the day something is damaged, lost, or claimed for, the inventory is the difference between a form and a catastrophe. It is also, quietly, the document that protects **you**, because the person without an inventory is the person who cannot prove what was there when they arrived.

CHAPTER VIII

Staff

Coordination without authority, which is the normal condition of your role

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Coordinate people you do not manage.

Understand the two rules that decide whether the staff make you or end you.

8.1 · The structural problem of your job

You will very often be responsible for a household without having authority over the people in it. The housekeeper does not report to you. The driver has been there eleven years. The chef answers to the principal directly, and knows it.

This is not a flaw in your position. It is your position, and the people who cannot operate inside it do not last, and they usually leave complaining that nobody respected their role.

8.2 · The two rules

RULE ONE

Credit goes down, and responsibility comes up.

When it goes well, it was the team. When it goes badly, it was you, in front of the principal, without exception and without qualification, even when it was demonstrably someone else. You will do this three or four times, and the staff will notice all four, and they will decide about you permanently.

RULE TWO

You correct in private, once, factually, and you never repeat it to anyone.

A member of staff corrected in front of another member of staff is an enemy for the rest of your time in that house, and their view of you will reach the principal by a route you cannot see and cannot answer.

8.3 · The mechanics

Instrument	What it does
The weekly staff brief	Fifteen minutes. What is happening this week, who is where, what is unusual. It removes ninety per cent of household friction and almost nobody does it.
The rota	Written, visible, and honoured. Changing someone's day off at short notice, twice, will cost you more loyalty than any gesture will buy back.
The handover	Between shifts, between staff, between you and your cover. Written, not spoken. Spoken handovers are how things get lost.
The escalation line	Everyone knows what they escalate, to whom, and how fast. A house where people do not know when to escalate is a house that finds out about problems late.

CHAPTER IX

Systems and the handover file

The document that proves you are a professional

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Build a household manual.

Understand why making yourself replaceable makes you valuable.

9.1 · The counterintuitive point of the whole week

Most people in this profession protect their position by being the only one who knows. The passwords are in their head. The suppliers answer only to them. The system exists nowhere except in their own memory.

They believe this makes them indispensable. **It makes them a risk**, and a house that identifies a risk removes it, calmly, at a convenient moment, with a good reference.

The professional does the opposite. She writes everything down, hands it over completely, and takes three weeks of holiday during which nothing happens. And **that** is the person who is promoted, because she has demonstrated the only thing that actually matters at the senior level: that the house runs.

9.2 · The household manual

Section	Contents
The house	How everything works. Systems, codes held in the correct place, suppliers by category, the maintenance calendar, the quirks that nobody writes down and everybody discovers at midnight.
The people	Who does what, when, and who to call. The staff, the office, the trusted contractors, the doctor, the security contact.
The standards	How things are done here. The table, the beds, the flowers, the cars, the arrival. Photographs where words fail, which is often.
The rhythms	The week, the month, the year. School terms, the trips that happen every year, the dates that matter and are never mentioned.

Section	Contents
The emergencies	One page. What to do, who to call, in what order. Printed and on the wall of the office, not in a folder.

CHAPTER X

When it breaks

The escalation protocol, and the thirty seconds you get

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Escalate correctly, and fast.

Deliver bad news in the format that a principal can act on.

10.1 · The three questions, in order, in ten seconds

- **Is anyone in danger?** If yes, nothing else in this document matters. Emergency services, then the office, then everything else.
- **Is it reversible?** If it is reversible, you fix it and you report it. If it is not reversible, you report it immediately, before you attempt anything at all.
- **Who needs to know, and how fast?** Almost always: faster than feels comfortable. Bad news does not improve with age. It compounds.

10.2 · The format

DEFINITION

The escalation. Four sentences. What happened. What it affects. What I have already done. What I need from you.

That is the whole thing. Not the story. Not the reasoning. Not who is at fault, which is a conversation for a calmer day and usually never. **Four sentences, in under thirty seconds, and then you stop talking and let them think.**

10.3 · The tone

Flat. Not dramatic, not apologetic, not defensive. The person who delivers a genuine crisis in a level voice is the person who is given the next one to handle, and being given the crises is how you become senior.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

Danger, then reversibility, then who needs to know. In that order, in ten seconds.

Escalate in four sentences: what happened, what it affects, what I have done, what I need.

Flat voice. The composure is the qualification.

Glossary

The brief · The instruction, completed by the six questions and confirmed in writing within the hour.

The confirmation · Your written restatement of an instruction. A statement of understanding, never a request for approval.

The black book · Your private, tiered, vetted list of suppliers. Its value is not the names. It is that they answer.

The threshold · The spending level above which you always ask. Established in week one, never tested.

Reconciliation · The monthly account of what was spent against what was budgeted, delivered before it is requested.

The advance · Arriving before the principal to resolve everything they would otherwise discover.

The seam · A handover between two parties. Where logistics fail, every time.

Empty leg · A repositioning charter flight sold cheaply. Useful, and never the plan for something that matters.

The walk-through · Ten minutes, alone, every room, weekly, with a notebook.

The household manual · The written system of the house. The document that makes you replaceable, and therefore promotable.

The escalation · Four sentences: what happened, what it affects, what I have done, what I need.

APA · Advance Provisioning Allowance. Twenty-five to thirty-five per cent of a yacht charter fee, paid in advance, held by the captain, spent on the family's behalf, and reconciled line by line at the end.

MYBA agreement · The standard Mediterranean yacht charter contract. Read the cancellation, delivery and weather clauses.

The charter broker · Represents you, the client. The central agent represents the yacht. Never confuse them.

The captain's authority · Absolute, aboard, in law. You pass on wishes and ask what is possible. You never instruct him.

Self-assessment

Answer in writing, before the practice.

1. Name the six domains, and give the characteristic failure of each.
2. Write the six questions of the brief. Then take this instruction and complete it: "Book somewhere nice for Thursday."
3. What is the single question that tests whether you have built a system rather than a dependency?
4. A supplier, charming and excellent, mentions in passing which other family they work for. What do you do, and why is there no exception to this?
5. A supplier offers you a fifteen per cent referral fee, which is standard in their industry. Write exactly what you say, and exactly what you then do.
6. You have been in a house for one week. Write the question you must ask about money, word for word.
7. Explain why petty cash is more dangerous than a hundred-thousand-euro renovation budget.
8. Where do logistics fail? Give three real seams from a London to Sardinia journey, and the named person on each side of each one.
9. Why does writing a complete household manual, which would allow anyone to replace you, make you more valuable rather than less?
10. The principal is quoted 200,000 for a week aboard a yacht. Explain, in three lines, what you actually present to them, and why the quoted figure is not the price.
11. What is the APA, whose money is it, and what are the three things you do about it during a charter?
12. The principal wants to be in Portofino on Thursday. Write, word for word, what you say to the captain, and explain what the wrong version would cost you.
13. Escalate this in four sentences: the renovation will miss its completion date by five weeks, and the family are due to move in.

Further study

- **Start your black book this week, honestly tiered.** You will find it is almost entirely tier 3 and tier 4, and that is normal, and knowing it is the point.
 - **Learn the vocabulary of charter aviation:** repositioning, empty leg, block hours, fixed base operator. You do not need expertise. You need to not be lost in the conversation.
 - **Read one household inventory, if you can find one.** Any insurer or valuer can show you the format. It will change how you look at a room.
 - **Take one instruction you received this week and complete it against the six questions.** Count how many were missing. It is usually four.
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